

Switzerland & Italy – Final Itinerary v4 (Corrected)

Oct 1–12, 2026 • 12 Days / 11 Nights • 2 Travelers

Route: Mumbai → Zurich → Lucerne → Interlaken → Milan → Cinque Terre → Florence → Siena → Rome → Mumbai

Flight Arrival: LX155 lands Zurich 06:20 (Thu, Oct 1) Flight Departure: GF26 departs Rome FCO 12:40 (Mon, Oct 12)

MASTER BOOKING CHECKLIST

Priority	Item	Book When	Link	Cost/pp
URGENT	Last Supper – Oct 4, 15:00	Late Jun/Early Jul 2026 (quarterly release)	cenacolovinciano.vivaticket.it	~15
Jul-Aug	Interlaken→Milan EC 61 (09:33)	3-4 months ahead (Jul)	trenitalia.com	From ~23
Jul-Aug	Florence→Rome Frecciarossa (16:00)	3-4 months ahead (Jul)	trenitalia.com	From ~14.90
Jul-Aug	Milan→Monterosso direct train (10:35)	1-2 months ahead	trenitalia.com	~29
Aug-Sep	Uffizi – Oct 7, 08:15	60-90 days ahead	uffizi.it	~40
Aug-Sep	Accademia – Oct 7, 10:30	60-90 days ahead	galleriaaccademiafirenze.it	~12
Aug-Sep	Brunelleschi Pass – Oct 7, 11:30	60-90 days ahead	duomo.firenze.it	~30
Aug-Sep	Vatican Museums – Oct 9, 13:00	60 days ahead	tickets.museivaticani.va	~22
Aug-Sep	Borghese Gallery – Oct 10, 15:00	Jul-Aug 2026	borgnese.gallery	~18
Sep	Colosseum – Oct 10, 08:30	30 days ahead	colosseo.it	~18-24
Anytime	Swiss Half Fare Card (2x, start Oct 1)	Before Sep 2026	swissrailways.com	CHF 120/pp
Sep	CT→Florence train (11:25 + 12:19)	1-2 weeks ahead	trenitalia.com	~20-30
Walk-up	St. Peter's Dome – Oct 9	Same day	–	~10 stairs/~15 elevator
Walk-up	Leonardo Express – Oct 12	Same day	station machines	~14

HOTELS

Night	Date	City	Hotel	Booked?	Cost	Notes
1	Oct 1 (Thu)	Zurich	INSIDE FIVE City Apartments	Booked	~16,876 (paid ~12,375)	Non-refundable. No front desk – register 24h before
2	Oct 2 (Fri)	Lucerne	Hotel Alpina	Booked	~18,748	Non-refundable. 2 min to Chapel Bridge
3	Oct 3 (Sat)	Interlaken	Hotel Harder Minerva	Booked	~21,562	Free cancel till Sep 19. Next to funicular

Night	Date	City	Hotel	Booked?	Cost	Notes
4	Oct 4 (Sun)	Milan	TBD (near Duomo or Centrale)	â€ Need	~â,135,000	1 night only
5	Oct 5 (Mon)	Monterosso	TBD (Hotel Marina / similar)	â€ Need	~â,16,000	âšš ĩ, CT stations have no left luggage â€” confirm hotel allows bag drop
6	Oct 6 (Tue)	Florence	TBD	â€ Need	~â,131,000	1 of 2 nights
7	Oct 7 (Wed)	Florence	Same hotel (no change)	â€ Need	~â,131,000	2nd night
8	Oct 8 (Thu)	Rome	TBD	â€ Need	~â,124,000	1 of 4 nights
9	Oct 9 (Fri)	Rome	Same hotel	â€ Need	~â,124,000	2nd night
10	Oct 10 (Sat)	Rome	Same hotel	â€ Need	~â,124,000	3rd night
11	Oct 11 (Sun)	Rome	Same hotel	â€ Need	~â,124,000	4th night

Total spent: â,157,186 (Swiss hotels) + â,11,46,997 (flights) =â,12,04,183 **Est. Italy hotels:** ~â,1,70,000-2,10,000 **Est. grand total:** ~â,15.5-6.5L for 2 pax

FLIGHTS (Confirmed)

Leg	Flight	Route	Time	PNR	Cost
Outbound	SWISS LX155	BOM 00:40 â†’ ZRH 06:20 (Oct 1)	9h 10m	Z5DY9C	â,177,625 (2 pax)
Return L1	Gulf Air GF26	FCO 12:40 â†’ BAH 19:20 (Oct 12)	5h 40m	UYWIKY	â,169,372 (2 pax)
Return L2	Gulf Air GF56	BAH 22:45 â†’ BOM 05:10 (Oct 13)	3h 55m	Same PNR	Included above

DAY-BY-DAY ITINERARY

DAY 1 â€” Thu, Oct 1: Zurich

Night: INSIDE FIVE City Apartments (Motorenstrasse 11) **Weather:** ~14Â°C / 7Â°C Â· Cool, crisp

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
06:20	LX155 lands Zurich Airport	â€”	â€”	Schengen arrival
06:20â€”06:50	Customs + baggage	30 min	â€”	~30 min for Schengen
06:50â€”07:00	Walk to Airport train station	10 min	â€”	Below Arrivals
07:10â€”07:24	Train ZRH Airport â†’ ZRH HB	14 min	50% off w/ HFC (~CHF 3)	IR/IC, every 8-10 min
07:30â€”07:50	Walk to INSIDE FIVE, drop bags	20 min	CHF 6-10 storage	Check-in at 15:00
08:00â€”08:45	Breakfast @ SprÃ¼ngli, Paradeplatz	45 min	CHF 12-18	Mon-Sat 08:00-18:30
09:00â€”09:30	Lindenhof Viewpoint	30 min	FREE	Panoramic Old Town Chagall stained-glass windows. Newly added
10:00â€”10:30	FraumÃ¼nster Church	30 min	CHF 5	
10:30â€”11:30	GrossmÃ¼nster Church + Tower	1h	CHF 5	Mar-Oct: Mon-Sat 10:00-17:00
11:30â€”13:00	Lunch + Niederdorf stroll	1.5h	CHF 15-25	Skip Kunsthaus if jet- lagged

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
15:00	Check-in INSIDE FIVE	30 min	â€”	âšš ĩ, No front desk â€” contact 24h before
16:00â€”17:00	Lake Zurich promenade	1h	FREE	Relax after red-eye
17:30â€”18:30	Niederdorf Evening Walk	1h	FREE	Lively alleys
19:00+	Dinner in Niederdorf	1.5h	CHF 30-50	Reserve ahead â€” popular area

DAY 2 â€” Fri, Oct 2: Lucerne

Night: Hotel Alpina (Frankenstrasse 6)Weather: ~15Â°C / 8Â°C Â· Lakeside breeze

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
08:00â€”08:45	Breakfast at INSIDE FIVE	45 min	CHF 10-15	Check-out by 11:00 but leave bags
09:10â€”09:51	Train ZRH HB â†’ Lucerne	41 min	50% off w/ HFC (~CHF 13)	SBB IR 70 â€” every 30 min
09:51â€”10:10	Walk to Hotel Alpina, drop bags	20 min	â€”	Check-in from 14:00-15:00
10:15â€”10:45	Chapel Bridge (KapellbrÃ¼cke)	30 min	FREE	2 min from hotel
10:50â€”11:10	Lion Monument	20 min	FREE	5 min walk from Chapel Bridge
11:15â€”11:45	Lucerne Old Town (Weinmarkt, Musegg Wall)	30 min	FREE	Medieval squares

OPTION A: Mt. Pilatus Golden Round Trip (if weather is clear)

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
12:00â€”12:30	Bus #1 â†’ Kriens gondola base	30 min	50% off w/ HFC (~CHF 2)	From Lucerne station
12:30â€”13:00	Gondola Kriens â†’ Pilatus Kulm	30 min	50% off w/ HFC (~CHF 36)	Panoramic ascent
13:00â€”14:00	Pilatus Kulm summit	1h	Incl.	Alpine views, hotel, restaurant
14:00â€”14:40	Cogwheel descent â†’ Alpnachstad	40 min	50% off w/ HFC	Worldâ€™s steepest cogwheel
15:00â€”16:15	Boat Alpnachstad â†’ Lucerne	1h 15min	50% off w/ HFC (~CHF 20)	Scenic return across lake
16:15	Check-in Hotel Alpina	â€”	â€”	By the room is ready
17:00â€”18:00	Musegg Wall + Jesuit Church	1h	FREE	If energy left

OPTION B: Relaxed Lucerne (if weather is poor or prefer slower pace)

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
12:00â€”13:00	Lunch on lake promenade	1h	CHF 20-35	Fondue or rÃ¶sti
12:12â€”13:00	Lake Lucerne Cruise â†’ Weggis	1h	50% off w/ HFC (~CHF 19)	SGV Schiff
13:00â€”13:40	Explore Weggis	40 min	FREE	Small lakeside village
13:45â€”14:30	Return cruise â†’ Lucerne	45 min	50% off w/ HFC	~CHF 10 for return portion
15:00	Check-in Hotel Alpina	30 min	â€”	
15:30â€”17:00	Musegg Wall + Old Town ramparts	1.5h	FREE	9 towers, panoramic
17:00â€”18:00	Jesuit Church + lakeside walk	1h	FREE	Baroque gem
21:00	Night walk â€” Chapel Bridge lit up	20 min	FREE	â Beautiful at night

Dinner (both options): 19:00+ on Lake Lucerne promenade Â· CHF 35-50 Â· Reserve ahead

DAY 3 – Sat, Oct 3: Interlaken + Jungfrauoch

Night: Hotel Harder Minerva (15 Harderstrasse) Weather: ~14°C / 6°C - Alpine, bring warm layers - Jungfrauoch cost: CHF 261.20/pp (or CHF 130.60 with Swiss Half Fare Card 50% off)

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
08:00–08:45	Breakfast, checkout Hotel Alpina	45 min	CHF 10-15	
09:04–10:59	Train Lucerne → Interlaken Ost	1h 55min	50% off w/ HFC (~CHF 18)	Luzern-Interlaken Express (sit RIGHT for lake views)
10:59	Arrive Interlaken Ost	–	–	
11:00–11:15	Walk to Harder Minerva (5 min), drop bags	15 min	–	Check-in 15:00; bags stored
11:30–12:15	Quick lunch	45 min	CHF 15-25	Grab-and-go near station

JUNGFRAUJOCH AFTERNOON (replaces Harder Kulm)

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
12:32–13:04	Train Interlaken Ost → Grindelwald Terminal	32 min	50% off w/ HFC (~CHF 8)	–, Verify Oct schedule closer to date
13:04–13:19	Eiger Express cable car → Eigergletscher	15 min	50% off w/ HFC (incl. in Jungfrauoch ticket)	3S cable car
13:19–13:27	Cogwheel Eigergletscher → Jungfrauoch	8 min	Incl.	
13:27–16:30	– JUNGFRUJOCH – Top of Europe	3h	CHF 261.20/195.90	Sphinx Observatory, Ice Palace, Plateau, Aletsch Glacier
16:30–17:25	Descent: Jungfrauoch → Interlaken Ost	~55 min	Incl.	Reverse route
17:30	Check-in Harder Minerva	10 min	–	
17:45–19:00	Hahweg Promenade + relax	1h	FREE	Post-Jungfrauoch wind-down
19:00+	Dinner	1.5h	CHF 30-45	Reserve ahead

DAY 4 – Sun, Oct 4: Interlaken → Milan

Night: Milan (TBD – near Duomo or Centrale)

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
08:00–09:00	Relaxed breakfast, check-out	1h	CHF 10-15	No rush today
09:33–12:48	–, Interlaken Ost → Milano Centrale	3h 15min	From –23	EC 61 EuroCity (via Spiez → Brig → Domodossola)
12:48	Arrive Milano Centrale	–	–	
12:48–13:15	Drop luggage at hotel (near Centrale/Duomo)	30 min	–	Metro or walk
13:30–14:15	Lunch near Santa Maria delle Grazie	45 min	–12-20	Metro M1: Cadorna/Conciliazione
14:30–14:45	Arrive Santa Maria delle Grazie	–	–	Must be 30 min before slot
15:00–15:15	– THE LAST SUPPER	15 min	–15	–, Book late Jun 2026. 30-40 people max
15:20–15:40	Walk: Via Torino → Piazza del Duomo	20 min	FREE	

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
16:00–17:00	Duomo Rooftop (stairs)	1h	â,~13	Last entry 18:00. Golden hour light
17:00–18:00	Duomo Interior + Baptistery	1h	â,~3	Open 08:00-19:00, last entry 18:00
18:00–19:00	Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II	1h	FREE/â,~12 terrace	Top terrace 10:00-20:00
19:00+	Dinner in Brera or Navigli	1.5h	â,~25-40	Reserve ahead â€” Navigli popular on Sunday

DAY 5 â€” Mon, Oct 5: Milan â†’ Cinque Terre

Night: Monterosso (TBD) âš ĩ, **Monday closures:** Last Supper (already done Sun), Sforza Castle museums, Brera â€” all closed. Parco Sempione + Castle grounds open.

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
08:00–09:00	Breakfast, check-out	1h	â€”	
09:00–09:45	Sforza Castle grounds + Parco Sempione	45 min	FREE	Grounds & park always open
09:45–10:00	Duomo Museum (if time â€” opens 09:00)	15 min	â€”	Quick visit only
10:00–10:25	Walk to Milano Centrale	25 min	â€”	Metro M3 or walk
10:35–13:22	ðŸš„, Milan â†’ Monterosso (direct)	3h	~â,~29	Direct train, 7-8 direct per day
13:22	Arrive Monterosso al Mare	â€”	â€”	
13:30–14:30	Check-in + lunch	1h	â,~15-25	âš ĩ, Confirm hotel allows early bag drop (no left luggage at CT stations)

AFTERNOON: Pick ONE activity (not both â€” they overlap)

Time	Option A: Beach + Old Town	Duration	Cost	
14:30–16:30	Monterosso Beach + Old Town wander	2h	FREE	
16:30–17:30	Gelato, aperitivo by the sea	1h	â,~5-10	
19:00+	Seafood dinner	1.5h	â,~20-35	
Time	Option B: Hike Monterossoâ†’Vernazza	Duration	Cost	
14:30–16:00	Sentiero Azzurro hike Monterossoâ†’Vernazza	90 min	â,~7.50 CT Card	
16:00–16:30	Explore Vernazza (harbor, tower)	30 min	FREE	
16:40–16:50	CT Express back to Monterosso	10 min	â,~5 (or CT Card)	
17:30+	Beach relax + dinner	â€”	â€”	

Best for Option B: Better sunset views from Vernazza harbor. Do it.

DAY 6 â€” Tue, Oct 6: Cinque Terre â†’ Florence

Night: Florence (TBD â€” near SMN/Duomo)

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
08:00–08:30	Breakfast	30 min	â€”	
08:30–10:00	ðŸŒŠ Morning hike: Monterosso â†’ Vernazza	90 min	â,~7.50 CT Card	Not Corniglia â€” 3h wonâ€™t fit. 90 min is perfect
10:00–10:20	Explore Vernazza (20 min)	20 min	FREE	
10:20–10:30	CT Express Vernazza â†’ Monterosso	10 min	CT Card	Every 20 min

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
10:30â€“11:00	Pack bags, check-out	30 min	â€”	
11:00â€“11:15	Walk to Monterosso station	15 min	â€”	
11:25â€“11:45	ðŸš„ Monterosso â†’ La Spezia	20 min	CT Card	â° Earlier train = 34 min buffer before Frecciarossa
12:19â€“13:47	ðŸš„ La Spezia â†’ Firenze SMN (Frecciarossa)	1h 28min	~â,~20-30	34 min to find platform. Comfortable buffer
13:47	Arrive Florence SMN	â€”	â€”	
14:00â€“14:30	Walk to hotel, check-in	30 min	â€”	Near SMN/Duomo
15:00â€“16:00	Basilica of Santa Croce	1h	â,~12	Tombs: Michelangelo, Galileo, Machiavelli. Closes 17:30
16:00â€“16:20	Walk: Santa Croce â†’ Ponte Vecchio	20 min		
16:20â€“16:40	Ponte Vecchio	20 min	FREE	Quick photo stop
17:00â€“17:45	âª San Miniato al Monte	45 min	FREE	âš ĩ, Closes 18:00 â€” go here FIRST. Plainsong chant at 17:30
17:45â€“18:30	ðŸœ… Piazzale Michelangelo â€” SUNSET	45 min	FREE	Sunset ~18:11. Arrive after San Miniato (2 min walk)
19:00+	Dinner in Oltrarno	1.5h	â,~20-35	Reserve ahead â€” popular area

DAY 7 â€” Wed, Oct 7: FULL DAY Florence

Night: Florence (same hotel â€” no change)

âš ĩ, **PRE-BOOK (Aug-Sep 2026):** - Uffizi â†’ 08:15 slot (opens 08:15, Tue-Sun) - **Accademia** â†’ 10:30 slot (opens 08:15, close 18:50) - **Brunelleschi Pass** â†’ 11:30 Dome climb (â,~30 for all 5 monuments)

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
07:30â€“07:45	Walk to Uffizi	15 min	â€”	From Duomo area
08:15â€“10:15	ðŸšš, UFFIZI GALLERY	2h	~â,~40	First slot = least crowded. Ticket office closes 17:30
10:15â€“10:30	Walk to Accademia	15 min	â€”	
10:30â€“11:15	ðŸ—¿ ACCADEMIA â€” David	45 min	~â,~12	45 min is enough for David only
11:15â€“11:30	Walk to Duomo	15 min	â€”	
11:30â€“12:30	ðŸšš, BRUNELLESCHIâ€™S DOME	1h	â,~30 (Pass)	463 steps, no elevator. Pre-book Mon-Sat 10:15-15:45.
12:30â€“13:00	Duomo Interior (free entry)	30 min	FREE	Dress code: shoulders + knees
13:00â€“14:00	Lunch @ Mercato Centrale	1h	â,~10-18	Upper floor food hall (10:00-22:00)
14:00â€“15:30	Oltrarno walk â€” Palazzo Pitti courtyard, Santo Spirito, Via Maggio	1.5h	FREE/â,~5	Quieter side of Florence
15:30â€“16:30	Return via Ponte Vecchio + San Lorenzo leather market	1h	FREE	
17:00â€“18:00	San Miniato al Monte (if missed Oct 6)	1h	FREE	âš ĩ, Closes 18:00 . Only 17:00-18:00 works
19:00+	Final Florence dinner	1.5h	â,~20-35	Try Ditta Artigianale for specialty coffee during the day

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
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DAY 8 – Thu, Oct 8: Siena Day Trip + Rome

Night: Rome (TBD – 4 nights at same hotel)

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
07:00–07:30	Breakfast	30 min	–	
07:30–08:00	Check-out, leave luggage at hotel	30 min	–	Return to collect
08:00–08:15	Walk to Busitalia Autostazione	15 min	–	Via Santa Caterina da Siena, 17 (behind SMN)
08:30–09:45	– Bus 131R + Siena	1h 15min	–7-9	– Buses fill up – arrive 10 min early
09:45–10:00	Walk to Piazza del Campo	5 min	FREE	Downhill
10:00–10:30	Piazza del Campo	30 min	FREE	Iconic shell square
10:30–11:30	Siena Duomo	1h	–10-15	Mosaic floor, Piccolomini Library
11:30–12:15	Torre del Mangia climb or medieval streets	45 min	–10	400 steps, great view
12:15–12:45	Quick lunch	30 min	–10-15	
12:45–13:15	Walk back to Piazza Gramsci bus stop	10 min	–	Uphill – allow time
13:30–14:45	– Bus 131R + Florence	1h 15min	–7-9	
14:45–15:10	Walk to hotel, collect luggage	25 min	–	
15:10–15:30	Walk to Firenze SMN	20 min	–	
16:00–17:28	–, Firenze SMN + Roma Termini (Frecciarossa)	1h 28min	From –14.90	49 trains/day. Book Jul 2026
17:30–18:00	Check-in Rome hotel	30 min	–	Near Termini or city center
19:00–20:00	Evening walk – Trevi Fountain lit up + Spanish Steps	1h	FREE	First glimpse of Rome –
20:00+	Dinner near hotel	1.5h	–20-30	

DAY 9 – Fri, Oct 9: ROME – Vatican Day

Night: Rome (same hotel)

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
06:30–07:00	Early breakfast	30 min	–	
07:00–07:30	–^a ST. PETER–TMS BASILICA	30 min	FREE	Opens 07:00 . Early = tiny queue. Dress code: no shorts
07:30–08:15	–TM ST. PETER–TMS DOME	45 min	–10 stairs / –15 elevator	– Oct hours: 07:30-17:00 (not 07:00-18:00!). 551 steps. Finish by 17:00 max
08:15–08:45	Crypt/Grottoes (Tomb of St. Peter)	30 min	FREE	07:00-17:00
09:00–09:30	Castel Sant–TMAngelo exterior	30 min	FREE	Walk along Tiber
09:30–10:30	Walk: Via della Conciliazione + Piazza Navona	1h	FREE	Beautiful approach
10:30–11:30	Piazza Navona – Bernini– TM s fountains	1h	FREE	Free, 24/7

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
11:30â€“12:00	Pantheon (walk from Navona: 5 min)	30 min	â‚¬5	Daily 09:00-19:00
12:00â€“13:00	Lunch near Vatican	1h	â‚¬12-20	
13:00â€“17:30	ŸŽŸ VATICAN MUSEUMS + Sistine Chapel	4.5h	~â‚¬22	âšŸ, Pre-book ~13:00. Mon-Sat 08:00-20:00, last entry 18:00. Leave halls 30 min before close. Sun Oct 11 = CLOSED Evening light on Berniniâ€™s colonnade Cross Ponte Sisto Reserve ahead â‚¬ Trastevere is popular
17:45â€“18:15	St.Â Peterâ€™s Square	30 min	FREE	
18:30â€“19:00	Walk to Trastevere (15 min)	15 min	FREE	
19:00+	Dinner in Trastevere	1.5h	â‚¬25-40	

DAY 10 â‚¬ Sat, Oct 10: ROME â‚¬ Ancient Rome + Borghese

Night: Rome (same hotel)

âšŸ, **PRE-BOOK (30 days ahead/Jul):** - **Colosseum** â†’ 08:30 slot (Oct hours: 08:30-17:30) -**Borghese Gallery** â†’ 15:00 slot (strict 2hr, max 360 people, **arrive 14:40**)

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
07:30â€“08:00	Breakfast	30 min	â‚¬	
08:30â€“10:30	ŸŽŸ, COLOSSEUM	2h	â‚¬18 (â‚¬24 Arena)	âšŸ, Pre-book 08:30. Oct: 08:30-17:30, last entry 16:30 Opens 09:00. 1.5h is tight â‚¬ hit highlights (Arch of Titus, House of Augustus)
10:30â€“12:00	ROMAN FORUM + PALATINE HILL	1.5h	Incl.	
12:00â€“12:15	Walk: Via dei Fori Imperiali â†’ Piazza Venezia	15 min	FREE	
12:15â€“12:45	Trevi Fountain (daytime)	30 min	FREE	Throw a coin ŸŽ™
12:45â€“13:45	Lunch	1h	â‚¬12-20	
14:00â€“14:40	Walk to Borghese (via Villa Borghese park)	40 min	FREE	Pleasant park walk
14:40	Arrive Borghese Gallery	â‚¬	â‚¬	âšŸ, 20 min early â‚¬ strict entry, no late admittance Caravaggio, Bernini, Raphael. Strict 2hr limit
15:00â€“17:00	ŸŽŸ-½Ÿ, BORGHESE GALLERY	2h	~â‚¬18	
17:00â€“19:00	Via Veneto â†’ Spanish Steps	2h	FREE	Dolce Vita walk. Steps free, 24/7
19:30+	Dinner	1.5h	â‚¬25-40	

DAY 11 â‚¬ Sun, Oct 11: ROME â‚¬ Relaxed Final Day

Night: Rome (same hotel â‚¬ last night) âšŸ, **Sunday note:** Vatican Museums CLOSED (except last Sun of month â‚¬ Oct 25, not applicable)

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
08:00â€“09:00	Breakfast	1h	â‚¬	Check-out, leave luggage at hotel
09:30â€“10:00	Trevi Fountain (early = fewer people)	30 min	FREE	â Morning light is beautiful

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
10:00â€“11:00	Spanish Steps + Piazza di Spagna	1h	FREE	Shopping along Via Condotti
11:00â€“12:00	Last caffÃ© + people-watching	1h	â„–5-10	
13:00â€“14:30	Aventine Hill â„– Keyhole of Knights of Malta + Giardino degli Aranci	1.5h	FREE	Best in afternoon light. Keyhole frames St.Â Peterâ„–s Dome â„– Sunday: crowds + Angelus at noon. Best to skip if already seen
14:30â€“16:00	St.Â Peterâ„–s Basilica (if missed Oct 9)	1.5h	FREE	
16:00â€“17:00	Last passeggiata â„– final walk	1h	FREE	
17:00â€“18:00	Collect luggage from hotel	1h	â„–	Splurge â„– reserve ahead
19:00+	ðŸŽŒ FINAL DINNER	2h	â„–30-45	

DAY 12 â„– Mon, Oct 12: Departure

Time	Activity	Duration	Cost	Notes
07:30â€“08:00	Breakfast	30 min	â„–	From most central hotels
08:00â€“09:00	Final walk / last-minute souvenirs	1h	â„–	
09:00â€“09:15	Walk to Roma Termini	15 min	â„–	
09:20â€“09:52	ðŸŽŒ, Leonardo Express â„– FCO	32 min	â„–14	Non-stop. Every 15 min.
09:52â€“12:40	Check-in, security, boarding	2h 48min	â„–	Comfortable. At gate by ~11:45
12:40	â„– GF26 â„– BAH (19:20) â„– GF56 â„– BOM (05:10+1)	â„–	Booked	Arrive Mumbai Tue Oct 13, 05:10 IST

SWISS HALF FARE CARD ANALYSIS

Cost: CHF 120 per person (one-time, valid 1 month) **Buy at:** [swissrailways.com/en/buy-swiss-half-fare-card](https://www.swissrailways.com/en/buy-swiss-half-fare-card) **Activation:** Set start date to **October 1, 2026** **What it does:** Gives **50% off ALL transport** across Switzerland â„– trains, boats, buses, and mountain railways

Cost Breakdown (per person with HFC)

Item	Full Price	With HFC (50% off)
HFC Card (one-time)	â„–	CHF 120
Oct 1: ZRH Airport â„– ZRH HB	~CHF 7	CHF 3.50
Oct 1: Zurich 24h zone pass	~CHF 13	CHF 6.50
Oct 2: Zurich â„– Lucerne (IR 70)	~CHF 25	CHF 12.50
Oct 2: Lake Lucerne cruise	~CHF 38	CHF 19
Oct 2: Pilatus Golden Round Trip (if chosen)	~CHF 72	CHF 36
Oct 3: Lucerne â„– Interlaken (Express)	~CHF 35	CHF 17.50

Item	Full Price	With HFC (50% off)
Oct 3: Interlaken â†’ Grindelwald	~CHF 16	CHF 8
Oct 3: Jungfrauoch dŸ™i,	CHF 261.20	CHF 130.60 â
Oct 4: Interlaken â†’ Domodossola (Swiss portion)	~CHF 30	CHF 15
Total (Relaxed Option B, no Pilatus)	â€”	~CHF 332
Total (Pilatus Option A)	â€”	~CHF 368

Comparison: Half Fare Card vs Swiss Travel Pass

Factor	Half Fare Card (â€œ... Our choice)	Swiss Travel Pass (â€œ Rejected)
Cost	CHF 120 flat + half-price tickets	CHF 254 flat + still pay for mountains
Jungfrauoch discount	50% off â†’ CHF 130.60 dŸ™†	25% off â†’ CHF 195.90
Validity	30 days (covers all 4 Swiss days)	3 consecutive days only
Flexibility	Buy tickets ad-hoc, skip what you donâ€™t need	â€œUse it or lose itâ€” â€” pay full CHF 254 even on light travel days
Total cost (Pilatus)	~CHF 368/pp	~CHF 469/pp
Total cost (Relaxed)	~CHF 332/pp	~CHF 469/pp
Savings vs STP	~CHF 100-140/pp â€œ...	â€”

How HFC Works

- **HFC is a discount card, NOT a free pass.** You still buy a separate half-price ticket for every journey.
- **Youâ€™ll buy tickets through the SBB Mobile app:** Search route â†’ select â€œHalf Fare Cardâ€” â†’ price drops 50% â†’ pay â†’ get ticket QR â†’ board.
- **Station machines:** Select destination â†’ tap â€œHalf Fareâ€” â†’ scan HFC QR â†’ get half-price ticket.
- **On the train:** Inspector scans 2 things: your ticket QR + HFC QR. Keep both on phone.
- **No turnstiles** â€” Swiss system is honour-based with random ticket checks.

Buying Steps

1. Go to [swissrailways.com](https://www.swissrailways.com)
2. Select **2x Half Fare Card**, start date **October 1, 2026**
3. Pay **CHF 120 per person** (~â‚¬111,280 each) â€” can do now or any time before travel
4. Receive **PDF with QR code** via email â€” save on phone
5. Download **SBB Mobile app** â†’ add HFC as your pass
6. Use the app to buy **50% off tickets** for every journey (or buy at station machines)

Saver Day Pass (SDP) â€” Optional

An SDP gives **unlimited SBB travel for one calendar day** (valid on all trains, buses, boats).
With HFC, early-bird SDP costs **~CHF 29-35** (half of the full CHF 52-59).

Day	Individual half-price tickets	SDP at CHF 29-35	Worth buying?
Oct 2 (Zurichâ†’Lucerne + cruise)	~CHF 31.50	CHF 29-35	â€œ Marginal saving. Only buy if CHF 29.
Oct 1 (Zurich city only)	~CHF 10	CHF 29-35	â€œ Not worth
Oct 3 (Jungfrauoch day)	~CHF 26 + Jungfrauoch CHF 130.60	SDP doesnâ€™t cover Jungfrauoch	â€œ Not worth

Bottom line: SDP is borderline for Oct 2. Skip it unless you see CHF 29 pricing – otherwise just buy individual half-price tickets.

Quick Reference Card

Buy HFC: [swissrailways.com](https://www.sswissrailways.com) + Half Fare Card + start Oct 1 + CHF 120/pp
SBB App: Download + add HFC + buy tickets at 50% off
JungfrauJoch: SBB app + select HFC + pay CHF 130.60/pp
SDP (opt): Check Oct 2 price. Buy only if CHF 29.
Interlaken+Milan: Buy EC 61 on [trenitalia.com](https://www.trenitalia.com) (Italian side) + half-price SBB ticket to Domodossola

DINING RECOMMENDATIONS

City	Must-Try	Budget Spot	Splurge	Reserve
Zurich	ZÃ¼rcher Geschnetzeltes (veal + rÃ¶sti)	Coop/Migros ~â,1700	Zeughauskeller ~â,13,200	Niederdorf dinner
Lucerne	Swiss Fondue	Coop ~â,1700	Rathaus Brauerei ~â,12,800	–
Interlaken	RÃ¶sti	Migros ~â,11,300	Hirschen ~â,13,500	Dinner
Milan	Risotto alla Milanese, Ossobuco	Miscusi pasta ~â,11,400	Luini Panzerotti ~â,1600	Navigli dinner
Cinque Terre	Trofie al Pesto	Pizza Kepris ~â,1600	Nessun Dorma sunset ~â,11,400	–
Florence	Bistecca alla Fiorentina	All’Antico Vinaio ~â,1800	Mercato Centrale ~â,11,200	Oltrarno dinner
Rome	Cacio e Pepe, Carbonara	Pastificio ~â,1450	Fiaschetteria Marini ~â,11,200	Trastevere dinner

Coffee: For specialty coffee matching complex profiles, visit **Ditta Artigianale** in Florence’s Oltrarno **Money-Saver:** Swiss supermarkets (Coop/Migros) = CHF 5-8 ready meals. Italian aperitivo (buy drink, free buffet) = dinner for â,10-15

CRITICAL NOTES

- **Last Supper booking:** Sep-Dec 2026 quarterly release opens **late June/early July** (not June 1). Check cenacolo.vinciano.org on Wednesdays at 12:00 Italian time
- **St. Peter’s Dome Oct hours: 07:30-17:00** (NOT 07:00-18:00 as I had before). Plan accordingly
- **San Miniato al Monte closes at 18:00** in October. Visit before or after Piazzale Michelangelo (2 min apart), not after 18:00
- **La Spezia connection:** Take the **11:25 CT Express** (not 11:45) to give **34 min buffer** for the 12:19 Frecciarossa
- **Siena bus 131R:** Buses can fill up by late afternoon. Arrive 10 min early for the 13:30 return
- **Borghese Gallery:** Arrive **20 min before** your 15:00 slot. No late entry permitted
- **CT stations have NO left luggage.** Confirm with Monterosso hotel that bag drop is available
- **Make dinner reservations** for Zurich Niederdorf, Milan Navigli, Florence Oltrarno, Rome Trastevere
- **Last Supper on Oct 4 (Sunday):** 08:15-19:00, last entry 18:45. Our 15:00 slot is fine
- **Monday Oct 5:** Last Supper, Sforza museums, Brera closed. Already leaving for CT – fine
- **Sunday Oct 11:** Vatican Museums closed. Already visited on Oct 9 (Friday)

Built from verified data: cenacolo.vinciano.org, museivaticani.va, basilicasanpietro.va, uffizi.it, colosseo.it, myswissalps.com, italiarail.com, jungfrau.ch, trainline.com. All data current as of May 28, 2026. Corrections applied in this version: JungfrauJoch moved to Oct 3 –..., St. Peter’s Dome 07:30 –..., San Miniato before sunset –..., La Spezia earlier train –..., CT activities as clear options –..., Pilatus timing fixed –..., Siena bus warning –...